

INDIA CLEAN AIR SUMMIT (ICAS) 2026

Air Without Borders: Scaling Air Quality Action Across Cities, States, and Regions



19–21 August 2026



Four Seasons Hotel Bengaluru



Concept Note

Over the past decade, India has made considerable progress in addressing air pollution through initiatives such as the National Clean Air Programme (NCAP). Key achievements include the expansion of monitoring networks; the development of city emission inventories, city action plans, source apportionment studies, and awareness programmes; and the allocation of funds for mitigation measures. These efforts have also contributed to advancing our understanding of air pollution sources at the local level, increased stakeholder awareness, and strengthened the evidence base to inform city- and state-level air quality management.

However, air pollution remains a complex challenge that extends beyond administrative boundaries. Pollutants travel across cities, districts, and states, creating shared air quality challenges that cannot be solved through isolated interventions alone. Further, pollution manifests differently at the local, city, and regional levels, calling for the planning and implementation of effective solutions at each level. The next phase of India's clean air journey, therefore, requires coordinated action across jurisdictions, sectors, and institutions, supported by robust scientific evidence and collaborative governance. The city-level strategies, too, must continue to build on the gains achieved by NCAP. There is also a need to assess the effectiveness of the current efforts to inform future planning.

As part of our work in 'Clean Air for All', the Center for Study of Science, Technology and Policy (CSTEP) is pleased to host the eighth edition of its flagship event, the India Clean Air Summit (ICAS) 2026, on 19–21 August 2026 at the Four Seasons Hotel Bengaluru. The theme for this year's event is 'Air Without Borders: Scaling Air Quality Action Across Cities, States, and Regions.'

ICAS 2026 will facilitate discussions on air quality management across multiple scales, from cities to states, regions, and the national level. In line with the summit theme, ICAS 2026 will also highlight the growing importance of airshed-based approaches for addressing transboundary air pollution through coordinated action.

Through technical training sessions, keynote talks, panel discussions, and research presentations, the summit will examine critical questions, including the following:

- How can airshed-based approaches strengthen air quality management in India?
- What interventions are most effective at local, city, state, and regional levels?
- How can neighbouring cities and states collaborate to address shared pollution sources?
- What is the need for a national emission inventory for air quality modelling and policy development in guiding coordinated action?
- How can clean air strategies be integrated with public health, climate, energy, transport, and urban development goals?
- What governance, financing, and institutional mechanisms are needed to support regional air quality management? How can the private sector be brought in to contribute both in terms of investments and technologies?
- What role can communities, citizens, and local stakeholders play in designing, implementing, and sustaining clean air interventions?

Reflecting the breadth of the summit programme, discussions will cover emissions science, air quality monitoring, modelling, decision-support tools, capacity building, translating scientific evidence into policy, and implementation.

Recognising the important role of the private sector, the summit will bring industry perspectives into the dialogue, showcasing technological innovations, cleaner production practices, digital solutions, and partnerships that can accelerate air pollution mitigation while supporting sustainable economic growth.

The summit will also explore the role of communities and citizen participation in driving clean air action, while drawing lessons from regional governance models and international experiences to strengthen collaborative air quality management. The summit will feature international best practices for improved sensor performance and assessment.

By bringing together diverse stakeholders and perspectives, ICAS 2026 aims to strengthen collaboration, promote knowledge exchange, and develop actionable pathways for cleaner air across cities, states, and regions. We invite policymakers, researchers, practitioners, industry leaders, and development partners to join us in shaping the next generation of integrated, science-based air quality management for India.

Join us at ICAS 2026!

About ICAS: The India Clean Air Summit (ICAS) is CSTEP's flagship event on improving air quality in India. Every year, ICAS brings together researchers, policymakers, practitioners, and academics from across the globe to discuss the air we breathe.

About Air Quality Sector: The Air Quality Sector at CSTEP supports government bodies in science-based air quality management at the city, state, and regional levels. We apply a wide range of advanced measurement and modelling tools to inform air pollution mitigation strategies.

About CSTEP: The Center for Study of Science, Technology and Policy (CSTEP) is a science and technology-based think tank with a mission to enrich policymaking using innovative approaches for a sustainable, secure, and inclusive society. Our interdisciplinary research cuts across energy, air quality, climate, development, and technology. CSTEP provides policy recommendations to governments, industries, and not-for-profit organisations for informed decision-making. We actively participate in government committees and collaborate with national and international research institutions to create a comprehensive understanding of policy challenges and solutions for India's sustainable development.
